LEAVE & TIME-OFF POLICY

People Operations | Policy ID: HR-LEAVE-001 | Version 1.0 | Effective date: 1 January 2026

Purpose. This fictional policy explains the leave available to employees of Intrix Solutions, how to request time off, and how unused leave is treated. It is a sample document created solely for the AI Engineering case study.

1. Scope and principles

This policy applies to full-time employees of the fictional Intrix Solutions organisation in India. Interns, consultants, temporary staff and employees covered by a separate written agreement should follow the terms stated in that agreement. Applicable law takes precedence wherever it provides a more favourable or mandatory entitlement.

Employees should plan leave in advance, keep their manager informed, and record approved leave in the company leave portal. Managers should assess requests consistently while considering business coverage.

2. Annual leave entitlements

Leave type	Annual entitlement	Typical use / notes
Casual leave (CL)	12 working days	Short personal needs; normally taken in half-day or full-day units.
Sick leave (SL)	10 working days	Personal illness, injury or medical appointments.
Earned / privilege leave (EL)	15 working days	Planned holidays and longer breaks; accrued monthly.

Entitlements are for a completed calendar year. Employees joining during the year receive a proportionate entitlement based on completed months of service. The leave portal is the official record of balances.

3. Casual leave

Employees receive **12 casual leave days per calendar year**. Casual leave is intended for unforeseen or short personal commitments. Employees should request it at least one working day in advance when practicable. For an emergency, notify the manager as soon as possible and submit the portal request when able.

4. Sick leave

Employees receive **10 sick leave days per calendar year**. If illness prevents an employee from working, they should inform their manager before the normal start time where possible. A medical certificate may be requested for an absence of more than two consecutive working days or where there is a repeated pattern requiring review.

Sick leave is not a substitute for earned leave when planning a holiday. Medical information should be shared only with the appropriate People Operations contact and handled confidentially.

5. Earned leave and carry-forward

Earned leave accrues at 1.25 working days per completed month, up to 15 days in a full calendar year. Employees should normally request planned earned leave at least five working days before the first day away. Longer periods may require additional notice so the team can plan coverage.

A maximum of **10 unused earned leave days** may be carried forward into the next calendar year. Any earned leave balance above 10 days at 31 December expires, unless People Operations confirms an exception in writing. Casual leave and sick leave do not carry forward and are not converted to cash under this sample policy.

Leave type	Carry-forward rule
Casual leave	No carry-forward; unused balance expires on 31 December.
Sick leave	No carry-forward; unused balance expires on 31 December.
Earned leave	Up to 10 unused days may carry forward; excess expires.

6. Request and approval process

1. Submit the dates and leave type through the leave portal. 2. The manager reviews team coverage and approves or declines the request in the portal. 3. Do not treat a request as approved until the portal shows approval or the manager confirms it in writing. 4. Before planned leave, hand over urgent work and share a reachable escalation contact if required.

7. Public holidays, weekends and half-days

Company-declared public holidays and weekly rest days are not deducted from an employee's leave balance when they fall within an approved leave period. A half-day absence is charged as 0.5 day where the portal supports half-day requests. Shift-based employees should confirm the applicable schedule with their manager.

8. Unplanned absence and extensions

If an employee cannot return on the approved date, they must contact their manager as soon as possible and request an extension. The additional absence is not automatically approved. If no leave balance remains, the manager and People Operations will discuss the appropriate treatment under the employee's contract and applicable law.

9. Business travel and leave

Approved business travel that takes place during an employee's scheduled working days is treated as work, not personal leave. An employee who adds personal days before or after a business trip must request and receive leave approval for those personal days. Travel expenses are governed separately by the Expense & Business Travel Policy.

10. Responsibilities and questions

Employees: request leave accurately, provide reasonable notice, and keep their manager informed. **Managers:** review requests promptly and plan coverage. **People Operations:** maintain policy guidance and resolve balance questions.

For questions or corrections to a leave balance, contact the People Operations team through the internal HR help channel. This sample policy is illustrative and does not create a real employment entitlement.

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